Overview: has life in Croatia become more affordable since 2010?

Everyday life became more affordable, housing less: real wages are 16.6 % above 2010 (EU: +4.5 %), but since 2015 house prices rose ~20 % more than wages.

Croatia

Wages and house prices: 2024 · GDP: 2025 (p)

Real wages vs 2010 (2010 = 100)	House prices vs wages (2015 = 100)	GDP per capita, PPS
116,6	119,5	32,370

GDP per capita vs EU

Croatia, 2025 (p) · EU27 = 100

GDP per capita, % of EU
77,6

EU27

Wages and house prices: 2024 · GDP: 2025

Real wages vs 2010 (2010 = 100)	House prices vs wages (2015 = 100)	GDP per capita, PPS
104,5	115,2	41,699

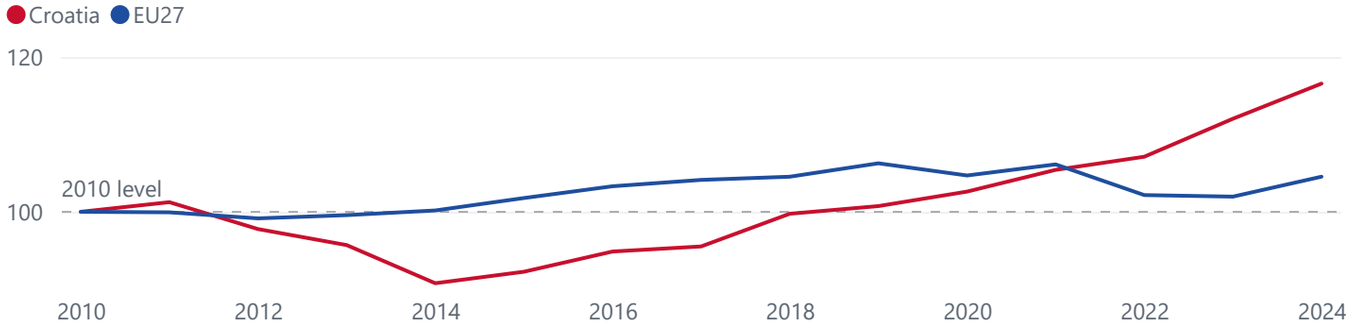
Unemployment vs EU

Croatia minus EU27, 2025

Unemployment rate gap
−1.1 pp

Real wages since 2010 (2010 = 100)

Gross wages deflated by HICP inflation



Key findings

- Real wages: Croatia 116.6 vs EU27 104.5 in 2024 (2010 = 100); 12th of 26 member states.
- Inflation hit 10.7 % (2022) and 8.4 % (2023), but wages grew faster: Croatian real wages rose 1.6 % and 4.6 % while EU real wages fell.
- Housing: 2015–2024 house prices +99 %, wages +67 %, so housing is ~20 % less affordable (EU: 15 %).
- Catching up: GDP per capita (PPS) rose from 61 % of the EU average in 2010 to 78 % in 2025 (p).

(p) provisional

Source: Eurostat (nama_10_fte, earn_nt_net, prc_hicp_minr, prc_hpi_q, une_rt_m, nama_10_pc), © European Union, CC BY 4.0.

Croatia vs EU

Croatian inflation was higher than the EU's (10.7 % in 2022), but wages outpaced it; unemployment fell from 17.4 % (2013) to 4.9 %, below the EU.

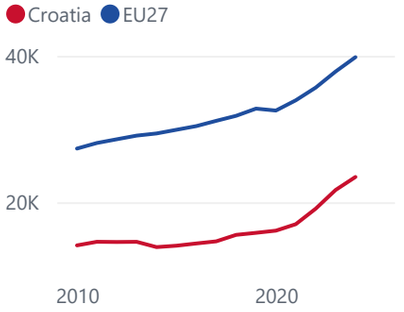
Country

Multiple selections

2010 2026

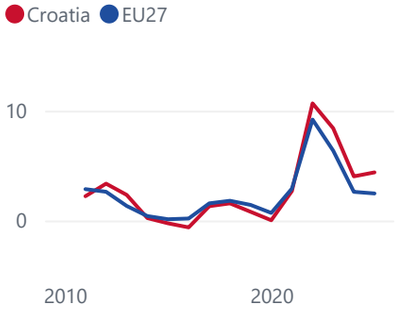
Average wage

National currency per year, full-time a...



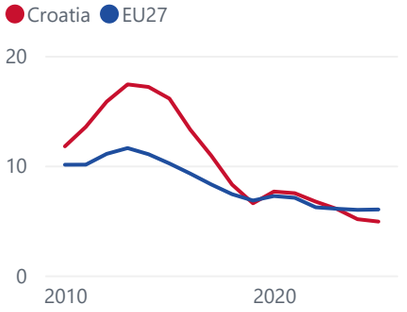
Inflation (annual average)

% change on previous year



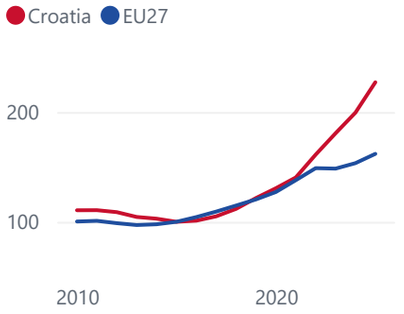
Unemployment rate

% of labour force



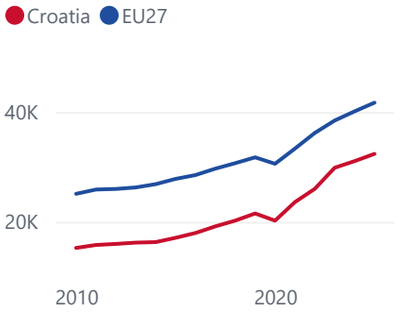
House price index

Index, 2015 = 100



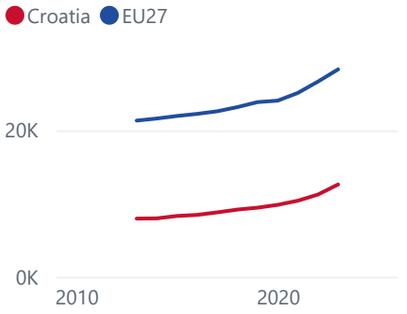
GDP per capita

PPS per inhabitant



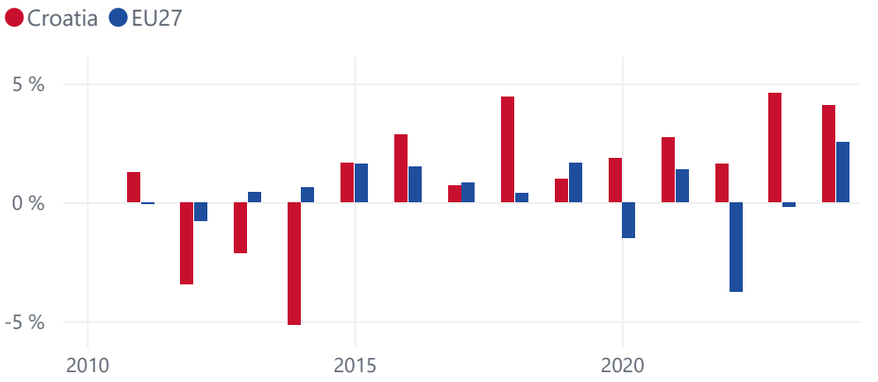
Net earnings (single person)

EUR per year, to 2023



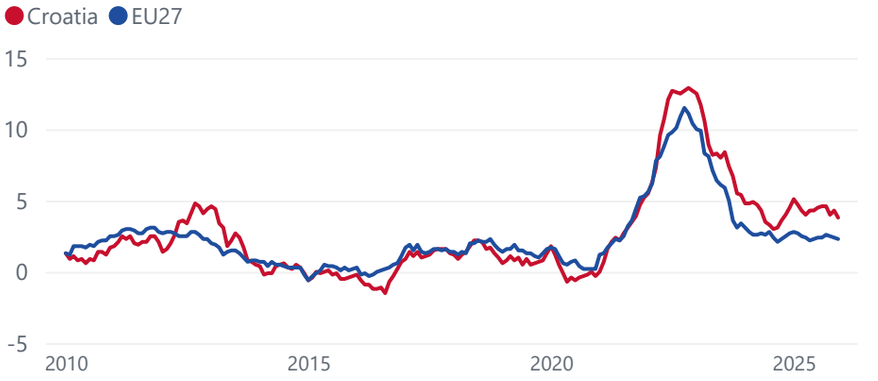
Real wage growth, % on previous year

Wages deflated by HICP inflation; hover a column for its value



Inflation, % on same month last year

Monthly HICP annual rate



Source: Eurostat (nama_10_fte, earn_nt_net, prc_hicp_minr, prc_hpi_q, une_rt_m, nama_10_pc), © European Union, CC BY 4.0.

Country comparison

Croatia is catching up: GDP per capita rose from 61 % to 78 % of the EU average (2010–2025 p), and it ranks 12th of 26 on real wage gains since 2010.

Indicator: GDP per capita (PPS)

Year: 2025

Selected indicator by country

Darker = higher. Blank for real wage growth and house prices vs wag…



Ranking among member states

Selected indicator and year; p = provisional

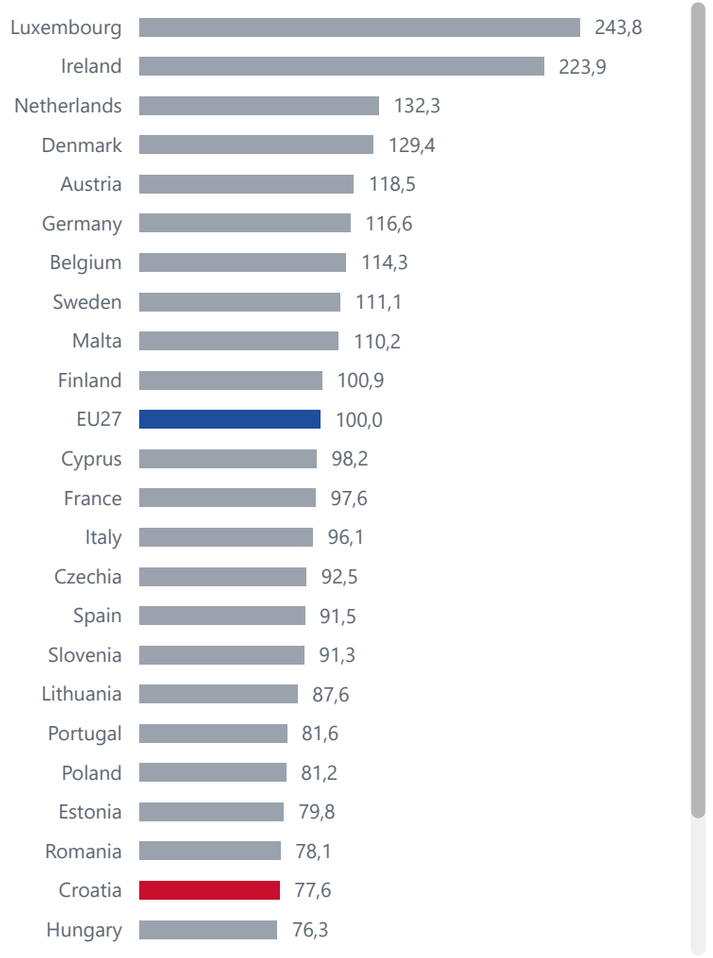
Country	Value	Rank	Of	Provisional
Croatia	32,370	22	27	True
Austria	49,398	5	27	False
Belgium	47,676	7	27	True
Bulgaria	28,332	27	27	True
Cyprus	40,957	11	27	True
Czechia	38,557	14	27	False
Denmark	53,941	4	27	False
Estonia	33,279	20	27	False
Finland	42,087	10	27	False
France	40,716	12	27	True
Germany	48,622	6	27	True
Greece	28,470	26	27	True
Hungary	31,816	23	27	True
Ireland	93,360	2	27	False
Italy	40,075	13	27	True
Latvia	29,715	25	27	False

Total

How ranks work: rank 1 = best. Higher is better for wages, earnings, GDP and real wage growth; lower for unemployment and house prices vs wages; inflation ranks by distance from 2 % (ECB target).

GDP per capita in PPS, EU = 100

Selected year; Croatia red, EU27 blue



Source: Eurostat (nama_10_fte, earn_nt_net, prc_hicp_minr, prc_hpi_q, une_rt_m, nama_10_pc), © European Union, CC BY 4.0.

Housing

From 2015 to 2024 Croatian house prices doubled (+99 %) while wages rose 67 %: housing is ~20 % less affordable (EU: 15 %), and prices rose 14 % more in 2025.

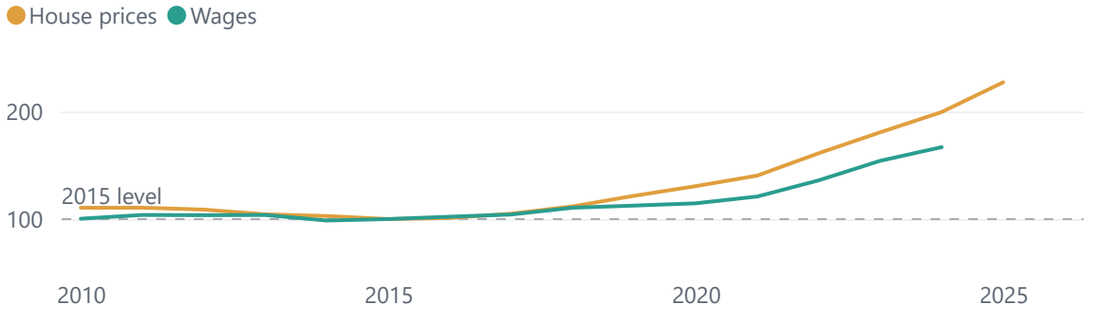
Country

Multiple selections

2010 2026

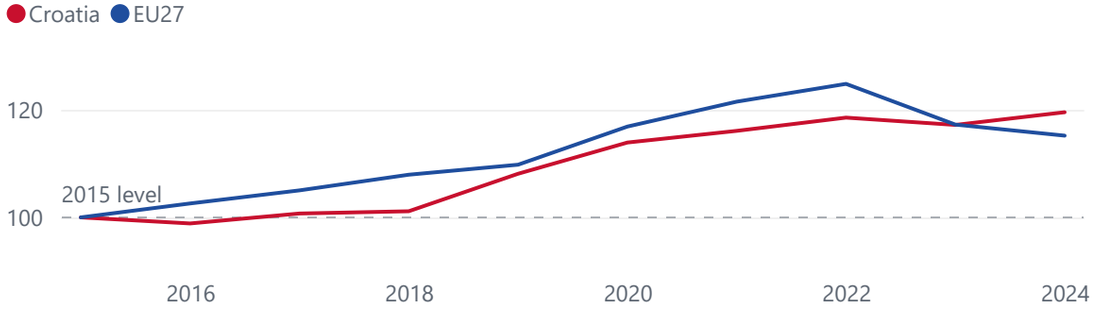
Croatia: house prices vs wages, 2015 = 100

Base year fixed to 2015 on this page; not filtered by the country slicer



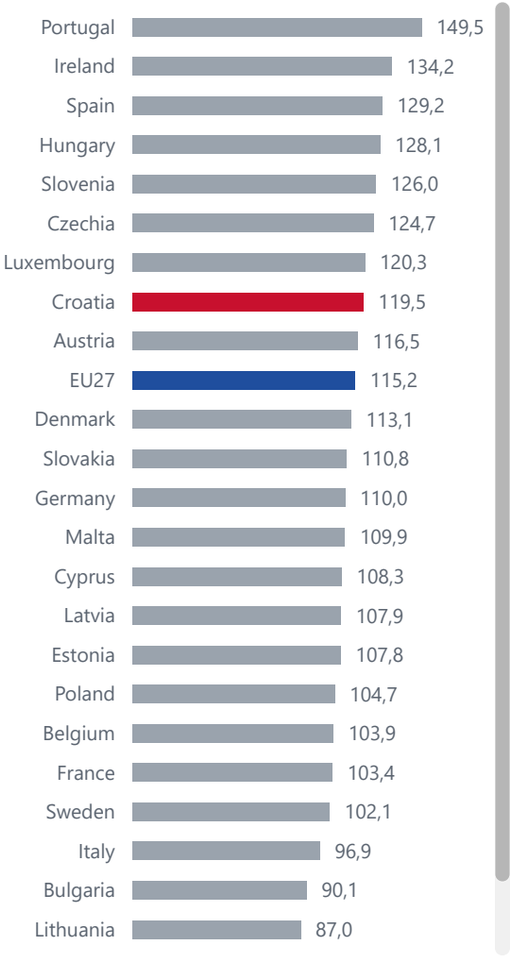
House prices relative to wages (2015 = 100)

Above 100 = less affordable than in 2015



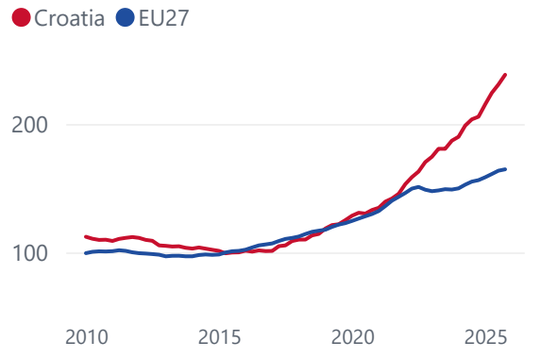
House prices vs wages, 2024

2015 = 100; latest year with wage data



House price index, quarterly

2015 = 100; runs past the last wage year



Why can real wages rise while housing gets less affordable?

Real wages are deflated by the HICP, which excludes owner-occupied housing costs and house purchases (Eurostat, 2023).

So rising house prices do not show up in consumer price inflation: wages can beat the HICP while falling behind house prices.

No data: Greece (house prices), the Netherlands (wages).

Source: Eurostat (nama_10_fte, earn_nt_net, prc_hicp_minr, prc_hpi_q, une_rt_m, nama_10_pc), © European Union, CC BY 4.0.

Data quality

The latest quality run passed all 54 checks; the 7 known gaps are documented cases where Eurostat publishes no data.

Latest quality run

Results of make quality, stored in quality.check_result

Run status	Finished	Checks passed	Checks failed	Warnings
passed	2026-10-10 12:10	54	0	0

Errors and warnings

Error: the pipeline run fails.
Warning: reported; the run still passes.
CI runs all checks weekly on live Eurostat data.

Results by check and status

Each check runs once per subject (country, indicator or dataset)

Check	pass	Total
Documented known gaps still match the data	8	**8**
Every country has every indicator from its start year	8	**8**
Latest Eurostat extract succeeded	6	**6**
Latest period not older than expected	7	**7**
No missing periods inside a series	8	**8**
Total	**54**	**54**

Open issues

Checks that did not pass; empty means every check passed

Check	Severity	Subject	Status	Issues	Message

Known gaps (accepted by the checks)

Eurostat publishes no data for these

Country	Indicator	Gap	Reason
Croatia	Net earnings (single person)	Missing 2010 to 2012	Series starts in 2013.
EU27	Net earnings (single person)	Missing 2010 to 2012	Series starts in 2013.
Cyprus	Net earnings (single person)	Missing 2010 to 2013	Series starts in 2014 within the project scope (2005-2007 exist before it).
Cyprus	Net earnings (single person)	Missing 2015 to 2016	Not published for 2015 and 2016.
Greece	House price index	No data at all	Greece does not report a house price index to Eurostat.
Netherlands	Average full-time adjusted salary, national currency	No data at all	Not published for the Netherlands (Statistics Netherlands uses a different method).
Netherlands	Average full-time adjusted salary, EUR	No data at all	Not published for the Netherlands (Statistics Netherlands uses a different method).

Source: Eurostat (nama_10_fte, earn_nt_net, prc_hicp_minr, prc_hpi_q, une_rt_m, nama_10_pc), © European Union, CC BY 4.0.